Xiaoting (Jasmine) Chen

+49 176-6958-6242 | chen@safe-frankfurt.de | https://www.linkedin.com/in/jasminechen1211/

EDUCATION

Goethe Universität Frankfurt am Main — Frankfurt, Germany
Ph.D in Finance — *Oct 2022 – Expected: 2028*
Quantitative M.Sc. in Finance — *Oct 2022 – May 2026*

Rheinische Friedrich-Wilhelms-Universität Bonn — Bonn, Germany
M.Sc. in Economics (Final grade: 1.9/1.0) — *Oct 2019 – Sept 2022*

WORK IN PROGRESS

How Do Households Respond to Perceived Income Uncertainty?
Job market paper; draft available upon request

- This paper studies how households' consumption, saving, and debt repayment respond to perceived income uncertainty alone, separate from changes in expected income. To answer this, I embed a novel vignette experiment in a nationally representative panel that holds expected income constant and manipulates only households' perceived income uncertainty. Results show that both the extensive and intensive margins of these decisions respond significantly and substantially to perceived uncertainty itself. Building precautionary saving and repaying debt faster operate as two separate channels. When the same households face different levels of income uncertainty captured by within-subject design, their decisions respond to the level of perceived uncertainty they currently face rather than to the path by which they arrived there. Households' balance sheet strength, measured by liquidity and debt leverage, is the main driver of this heterogeneous response. However, the ambiguity of an uncertainty realization does not matter to households; what matters is the size of the uncertainty itself.
- ***Presentation: SAFE Brown-bag Seminar (May), 4th BCFM PhD Conference (May), 10th Household Finance Workshop (June), Frankfurt Summer School 2026 (July), Deutsche Bundesbank Research Center Internal Seminar (August 2026), 7th Joint Conference on Expectation Survey by BoC, NY Fed, ECB, and Bank of Mexico (November 2026)***

Intra-household Perceived Unemployment Risk and Portfolio Decisions
with Olga Goldfayn-Frank, Nathanael Vellekoop, and Michael Haliassos

- When a spouse can step up earnings during unemployment, households need less precautionary savings and can bear more financial risk—theory is clear on both predictions. Yet households rarely behave as models suggest, and the reasons remain poorly understood. We study this using the LISS panel, which uniquely elicits insurance beliefs from both partners within the same household. Households expecting partner support hold significantly less liquidity, confirming the precautionary-savings channel. Yet, contrary to theory, stronger expected insurance is associated with lower, not higher, risky asset holdings. Behind this disconnect lies a striking belief asymmetry: individuals consistently believe they will provide more support than their partner will. This is not simply a gender story—it reflects deeper inequality in labor market participation, which may leave insured households too financially constrained to also take on portfolio risk. We are linking the survey data with administrative records to test whether these beliefs are well-founded or systematically biased.

What If the Benchmark Is (Actually) Two? Professional Forecasters' Accuracy vs. Calibration
with Nils Eitner and Christian Schlag

- Professional forecasters are conventionally treated as a homogeneous rational benchmark. Existing literature distinguishes model users from non-model users but evaluates forecast quality based on point estimation alone. We exploit the full density forecasts from the SPF surveys, going beyond the mean to apply strictly proper scoring rules that incentivize truthful reporting of the entire distribution. Using data from the ECB SPF (1999–2025) and Fed SPF (2007–2025), we assess accuracy via the Continuous Ranked Probability Score (CRPS) and calibration via Probability Integral Transform (PIT) tests. Model users achieve significantly better CRPS pre-2019, driven by their more dispersed probability assignments across density bins including tail risks, while non-model users systematically concentrate mass and under-report uncertainty. PIT analysis confirms both groups are miscalibrated, with non-model users showing greater deviation from uniformity. We further propose a distributional generalization of the Coibion-Gorodnichenko (2015) regression, replacing point-forecast errors with CRPS and Cramér distance. Results have implications for asset pricing models with heterogeneous expectations.

Teaching & Research Assistant Experience

Deutsche Bundesbank Research Center, Dr. Olga Goldfayn-Frank
PhD Intern, Frankfurt, Germany — *May 2026 – Present*

- Work on a collaborative research project with Bundesbank economists using household survey and administrative data

Leibniz Institute for Financial Research SAFE, Prof.Christine Laudenbach
Research Assistant, Frankfurt, Germany — *Oct 2023 – Present*

- Conduct code replication and validation to ensure reproducibility before publication
- Bachelor and Master Thesis supervision

Goethe University Frankfurt, Prof. Michael Haliassos
Teaching Assistant, Frankfurt, Germany — *2024, 2025 Summer Semester*

- 1st Teaching Prize, Summer Semester 2025, shared with the whole teaching team

MacroFinance & MacroHistory Lab, Prof. Moritz Schularick
Research Assistant, Bonn, Germany *Oct 2021- Jul 2022*

- Responsible for updating all financial variables in the 2018–2021 Schularick–Taylor Macrohistory Database
- Received the Engerman-Goldin Prize (2022) with the team for our update of the Jordà-Schularick-Taylor Macrohistory Database

Honors, Awards, and Grants

Pilot Grant (€300), SAFE & Frankfurt Laboratory for Experimental Economic Research (July 2025)
Best Discussant Award, 8th Household Finance Workshop (July 2024)
Nomination, Norbert-Walter-Förderpreis (Summer Semester 2024)
PhD Stipend, SAFE 1st Year PhD student Stipend (Full Year 2022)

Professional Activities

The Chicago School in Experimental Economics Bonn, Germany
Fully funded summer school (Admission rate: 60/450) *2025*

Annual Household Finance Workshop Bad Nauheim, Germany
Organizing Assistant (2 ×); Presenter *2024–2026*

Bonn–Cologne–Frankfurt–Mannheim PhD Conference Rotating, Germany
Organizing Committee (2 ×); Presenter *2024–2026*

Women in Economics Initiative Online, Global
Mentoring Program Designer & Coordinator *2021–2025*

ADDITIONAL

Software: Python, RStdio, STATA LaTex, EIKON DataStream (Macroeconomics database)
Developer Tools: GitHub, VS Code, Anaconda, Jupyter Notebook
Multilingual: Mandarin (native), English (fluent), German (B1), Traditional and ancient Chinese
Others: Fencer with Eintracht Frankfurt